

SAP Clean Core Extension Classification Rules

A / B / C / D Level Overview | Based on SAP Clean Core Extensibility White Paper

Extensions are classified by the type of SAP objects they use. The overall level of an extension is determined by its lowest-ranked component.

A

Level A — Fully Clean

Cloud development using only Released APIs with formal Stability Contract

Core Rule:

Only released SAP interfaces may be used. All objects are governed by a Stability Contract.

- On-stack: ABAP Cloud development model, using released local APIs (CDS Views, BO interfaces, extension points)
- Side-by-side: ABAP Cloud, CAP or low-code tools (SAP Build) on SAP BTP, released remote APIs only
- Discovery: All released interfaces are listed on SAP Business Accelerator Hub

ATC:
No finding

Risk:
Lowest

Examples:
CDS View, BTP OData API, SAP Build App

B

Level B — Conditionally Clean (Classic APIs)

Classic APIs nominated by SAP experts — upgrade-stable but no formal contract

Core Rule:

Uses SAP "classic APIs": well-established, documented interfaces without formal stability contracts.

- Uses BAPIs, User Exits, BADIs, SAP GUI, ABAP List Viewer (e.g. CL_GUI_ALV_GRID)
- Developed with ABAP standard language version, no restricted objects referenced
- Identified via Cloudification Repository (state = Classic API)

ATC:
Priority 3 (Info)

Risk:
Low

Examples:
BAPI_PO_CREATE1, CL_GUI_ALV_GRID, User Exit

C

Level C — Conditionally Clean (Internal Objects)

Uses SAP-internal objects — not released, not recommended, no stability guarantee

Core Rule:

Accesses SAP internal objects that are neither released nor classic. No documentation or long-term stability guaranteed.

- Direct use of internal function modules, classes, or read-only access to SAP standard tables
- SAP technically allows access but provides no support or compatibility guarantee
- Mitigation: Use "Changelog for SAP Objects" to detect breaking changes before upgrades

ATC:
Priority 2 (Warning)

Risk:
Medium

Examples:
Unreleased function modules, read SAP tables

D

Level D — Not Clean Core

Uses "not recommended" objects or techniques — highest upgrade risk and technical debt

Core Rule:

Uses objects or patterns explicitly classified by SAP as "not recommended" (noAPI, modifications, etc.).

- Objects marked noAPI in Cloudification Repository (filter: state = noAPI)
- Modifications to SAP standard code / direct write access to SAP standard tables
- Implicit enhancements or other explicitly forbidden extension techniques

ATC:

Priority 1 (Error)

Risk:

HIGHEST

Examples:

Modified SAP code, write to SAP tables

Quick Reference Table

Level	Keywords	Risk	Examples	ATC P
A	Released API, ABAP Cloud, SAP Build, Stability Contract, Business Accelerator Hub	Lowest	CDS View, BTP OData API, CAP, SAP Build	No finding
B	Classic API, BAPI, User Exit, BAdl, SAP GUI, Cloudification Repository	Low	BAPI_PO_CREATE1, CL_GUI_ALV_GRID	Priority 3
C	Internal Object, unreleased FM, internal class, SAP table read access	Medium	Unreleased function modules, read SAP tables	Priority 2
D	noAPI, Modification, Implicit Enhancement, write SAP table, not recommended	HIGHEST	Direct SAP code modification, write standard tables	Priority 1

Golden Rule

The overall level of an extension is determined by its LOWEST-ranked component.
Example: an extension using both Level A and Level C objects is classified as Level C overall.
Recommendation: Always aim for Level A (BTP-first strategy). Prioritize immediate remediation of Level D objects.

Level D: Immediate Action Required

Level D extensions represent the highest risk. They should be identified, prioritized, and removed or refactored without delay.